THE SOLO-PUP PROTOCOL

THE 30-Day HOME ALONE CHALLENGE

Turn your panicked, velcro dog into a calm, confident, independent companion.

Days 1–7	Days 8–14	Days 15–21	Days 22–30
Foundation	**Desensitization**	**Incremental Distance**	**Real-World Resilience**

FREE — DAYS 1 & 2

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

You already know something is wrong.

You pick up your keys and your dog starts to pace. You put on your coat and they begin to whine. You close the front door and somewhere behind it — they fall apart.

You've come home to scratched doors. Chewed furniture. Neighbours who've knocked. A dog who greets you like you've been gone for a year — every single time.

You've tried ignoring it. You've tried treating it. You've tried the advice online. Nothing has held.

Here is what nobody told you:

Your dog is not being difficult. They are panicking.

Separation anxiety is not a behaviour problem. It is a clinical stress response. Your dog's nervous system is in survival mode the moment you leave — sometimes before you leave. And no amount of scolding, ignoring, or hoping will rewire a nervous system.

A protocol will.

That is what the next two days are.

Read every word. Do the work. Your dog has been waiting for this.

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YOUR FREE PREVIEW

You've Already Done the Hardest Part.

You picked this up on the right day. What you are holding is not a pamphlet of tips — it is a precision-engineered, 30-day behavioural system built on the science of systematic desensitisation, counter-conditioning, and functional relaxation. Dogs who complete this protocol go from unable to be alone for 60 seconds to calm, settled, and genuinely confident for 4 hours. That transformation is not a promise. It is a documented outcome. Your only job is to begin.

WHAT'S INSIDE THIS FREE PREVIEW

- Day 1 — Find Your Dog's Threshold (your most important baseline)
- Day 2 — Cut the Velcro in Half (no absence required)
- The Protocol Contract — 6 non-negotiable rules
- Counter-Intuitive Pro-Tips for Days 1 & 2

HOW TO USE THIS WORKBOOK

1. Read the full Mission & Action Steps before beginning each session.
2. Set up your camera. Never train without footage to review.
3. Complete the Victory Metric immediately after the session — while memory is fresh.
4. Answer the Reflection Question honestly. These insights compound over time.
5. On Rest Days, honour the rest. Recovery is not optional — it is the protocol.

▲ **COUNTER-INTUITIVE PRO-TIP**
Photograph your dog each morning using the same angle and lighting. By Day 30, the visual record of their body language will be your most powerful proof of progress.

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THE PROTOCOL CONTRACT

Your 6 Non-Negotiable Rules

This is why PAXA works when everything else hasn't. Most advice fails because it is inconsistent. A tip here, a trick there — none of it adds up to a rewired nervous system. These 6 rules are the difference between a dog that improves and a dog that stays stuck. They are not suggestions. They are the protocol. Every owner who has seen real results followed all six.

1

Always Use a Camera

You cannot guess what your dog is doing behind a closed door. A camera is your eyes when you're absent. Review footage after every session.

2

Never Punish

Never punish destruction or accidents that happened while you were away. Your dog is not being defiant — they are experiencing panic. Punishment destroys trust and regression is guaranteed.

3

Keep Hellos & Goodbyes Calm

No emotional farewells or excited returns. The arrival and departure should be functionally invisible. This is one of the highest-leverage habits in the entire protocol.

4

Cap Training at 30 Min/Day

Cap targeted training at 30 minutes per day and take one full rest day every week. Over-training is just as harmful as under-training. The nervous system needs recovery to consolidate learning.

5

Uphold the Contract

Your dog must never experience a full panic attack during training. If they breach threshold — return immediately. A single flooding event can set back weeks of progress.

6

Exercise Before Every Session

Always exercise your dog before any isolation practice session. A tired dog is a trainable dog. Physical depletion lowers baseline cortisol and dramatically improves session outcomes.

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PHASE ONE

FOUNDATION

Build the emotional and environmental platform.

Days 1–7 are about calm, not distance.

DAYS 1–7

1

DAY 1 OF 30 · PHASE 1 · FOUNDATION

DAY 1

Find Your Dog's Threshold

Establish your scientific baseline. You cannot improve what you cannot measure.

Today you are not training — you are diagnosing.

1

THE ACTION STEPS

1. Set up a camera in the room where your dog typically stays when alone.
2. Leave the house as you normally would, with no special preparation or fanfare.
3. Monitor the camera feed from outside. Start a timer the moment you close the door.
4. Record the exact timestamp when the first sign of anxiety appears (pacing, vocalising, scratching).
5. Return immediately — do not let the session exceed your dog's threshold.
6. Log the threshold time below. This number is your most important baseline metric.

▲ COUNTER-INTUITIVE PRO-TIP

The threshold is not when your dog looks slightly bored — it's the first sign of genuine distress: repetitive movement, vocalisation, or body tension. Be honest. Many owners underestimate severity at this stage.

VICTORY METRIC · RECORD YOUR RESULTS

THRESHOLD TIME (MIN:SEC)	FIRST ANXIETY SIGN OBSERVED	SESSION LENGTH
—	—	—

REFLECTION QUESTION

"What did you notice about your dog's body language in the 60 seconds before anxiety began?

Did any specific trigger seem to initiate it?"

Your observations here…

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